

» WORLD VIEW OF THE FORTNIGHT



« As it pertains to the USA, we have not had a communication. We look forward to meeting the vice president. – Kirsty Coventry, the International Olympic Committee president, when asked if there had been any talks with the White House in recent months over preparation for the Los Angeles Olympics »



« I just don't see a world where it can happen at this point. – Rory McIlroy, who believes the PGA Tour and LIV Golf have grown "too far apart" to form an alliance and bring a splintered sport back together »

1500m

Nine-time Olympic gold medallist Katie Ledecky clocked the second-fastest women's 1500m freestyle time in history at the US Pro Swim Series in Austin, Texas, sealing a dominant victory. Ledecky was untouchable as she cruised home in 15:23.21, finishing more than a minute ahead of 16-year-old runner-up Brinkleigh Hansen, who touched in 16:31.31. Becca Mann placed third in 16:35.09. Ledecky did not threaten her world record of 15:20.48, set in 2018, but produced a strong closing surge to improve on the previous second-best time

of 15:24.51, which she had set at the Pro Swim Series in Fort Lauderdale last April. Since then, she has gone on to win her sixth world title in the event at last year's World Championships in Singapore. She has also won both Olympic gold medals available in the event, in the Tokyo Olympics and the Paris Olympics, since the women's 1500m freestyle was added to the Olympic programme.



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Seven athletes from the 2016 Rio de Janeiro Olympics, including one bronze medallist, tested positive for doping in fresh analysis of their samples, said the International Testing Agency (ITA). The athletes included weightlifting medallist Aurimas Didzbalis of Lithuania and sprinter Ivet Lalova of Bulgaria, who placed eighth in the women's 200 metres final.

CLASSIC VICTORY



Patrick Reed took his fourth title on the DP World Tour, winning the \$9 million (£6.6m) Dubai Desert Classic by four shots. Reed became the sixth American to win the Dubai Classic, with the victory set to move him to No. 2 in the Race to Dubai Rankings, and up 18 places to 26th in the official world rankings. AFP